PPP-B-1089C
July 10, 1978
SUPERSEDING
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July 20, 1972

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BAG, PLASTIC (PRODUCE AND POULTRY)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for plastic bags for the packaging of food items.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and styles. The bags shall conform to one of the following types and styles, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - Perforated (see 3.2.2).
  Style 1 - Flat (see 3.2.4).
  Style 2 - Square (see 3.2.5).

Type II - Nonperforated (see 3.2.3).
  Style 1 - Flat (see 3.2.4).
  Style 2 - Square (see 3.2.5).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Philadelphia, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Houston, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for its Enforcement.

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for issuance thereof.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The bags shall be fabricated from untreated, colorless, transparent polyethylene film intended for use in direct contact with food, and shall conform to the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, Food Additive Amendment. The required thickness of the film shall be as specified for the corresponding bag dimension in table I. For thicknesses ranging from 0.0010 to 0.0014 inch, a tolerance of plus or minus 25 percent shall be permitted; for thicknesses ranging from 0.0015 to 0.0090 inch, a tolerance of plus or minus 20 percent shall be permitted when tested, as specified in 4.4.2.

3.1.1 Wire ties. The wire ties shall be nominal 26 gage (0.018 inch in diameter) wire covered with plastic or paper so that the strip is a minimum of 3/16 inch in width. Each tie shall be not less than 4 inches in length.

3.2. Construction. All seams shall be sealed by normal manufacturing practice. (See 3.2.1 for seam strength requirement.)

3.2.1 Seam strength. The seam strength, when tested as specified in 4.4.1, shall hold a static load without peel back or slippage of the seam.

3.2.2 Type I. The type I bags shall be perforated (except for the upper 4-1/2 inches ± 1/2 inch) with holes which are 1/4 inch in diameter, ± 1/16 inch that are evenly spaced from center to center horizontally and perpendicular to each other and to the edges of the bag. Each perforation shall be cut cleanly through the thickness of the bag material and shall be free of clinging pieces. The bags shall have the number of perforations specified in table I with a ± 15 percent tolerance allowed for the size of bag specified.

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3.2.3 Type II. The type II bags shall not be perforated.

3.2.4 Style 1. The style 1 flat bags shall not have gussets.

3.2.5 Style 2. The style 2 square bags shall have gussets on the sides.

3.3 Dimensions. The specified dimensions of the bag shall be the inside measurements with a tolerance of ± 1/4 inch (see table I).

3.4 Printing. When specified (see 6.2), the bags shall be printed as described in the contract or order.

3.5 Form (put-up). The bags shall be furnished as individual bags.

3.6 Workmanship. The bags shall be uniformly made; free from pinholes, tears, cuts, creases and wrinkles.

TABLE I. Requirements, types I and II

Dimensions ± 1/4 inches					(Type I only)	
Length	Width	Depth	Thickness	tolerance	No. of perforations	tolerance
6-3/4	4	2-3/4	0.001	± 25%	16	± 15%
14	5-1/2	3	.001	± 25%	16	± 15%
18	6-1/2	3	.001	± 25%	16	± 15%
12	4	2	.0013	± 25%	32	± 15%
13	5	3-1/2	.0013	± 25%	40	± 15%
14	5	3-1/2	.0013	± 25%	40	± 15%
15	6	3	.0013	± 25%	48	± 15%
20	8	3	.0013	± 25%	56	± 15%
10	6-1/2	4-1/2	.0013	± 25%	32	± 15%
12	4	2-3/4	.0013	± 25%	32	± 15%
15	6-1/2	3	.0013	± 25%	48	± 15%
13	5-1/2	3	.0013	± 25%	40	± 15%
17	6-1/2	3	.0015	± 20%	16	± 15%
18	8	4	.0015	± 20%	16	± 15%
17	6	4	.0015	± 20%	16	± 15%
9	6	4	.0015	± 20%	32	± 15%
17	5	3	.0015	± 20%	16	± 15%
15	5	3	.0015	± 20%	40	± 15%
12	5	3	.0015	± 20%	32	± 15%
13	4	2	.0015	± 20%	32	± 15%
10	4	2	.0015	± 20%	32	± 15%
29-1/2	15	--	.003	± 20%	80	± 15%
13	5	3-1/2	.0015	± 20%	40	± 15%
16	5	3-1/2	.0015	± 20%	--	--
18	12	--	.0015	± 20%	--	--
15	8	--	.0015	± 20%	--	--

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government.

4.2 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3 Inspection of the end item.

4.3.1 Examination of the end item. The sample unit for this examination shall be one bag of each type and style, as applicable. The inspection level shall be S-3 with an AQL of 2.5 expressed in terms of percent defective.

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4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of percent defective.

4.4 Testing of end item. Testing shall be performed for seam strength and material thicknesses as indicated in 4.4.1 and 4.4.2, respectively. The sample unit shall be one bag for each test. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL 2.5 expressed in terms of percent defective. Samples should be stored under laboratory conditions for 1 hour before testing.

4.4.1 Seam strength. Cut a 1-inch wide sample from each seam of each sample bag. The cut shall be perpendicular to the line of the seam so that the sample has the seam in the center and has two ends or legs a minimum of 4 inches in length. Clamp one end or leg of the sample so that the rest hangs freely. Apply a static load (2 pounds for material 0.0015 thick or less; or, 3.5 pounds for material 0.003 inches thick) to the free end or leg. Allow the test load to exert a force on the seam for 5 minutes, examine the seam for slippage or peel back. Peel back shall be defined as any separation of the seam from the inside line of contact of the sealer.

4.4.2 Material thickness. The gage used for the measurement of thickness shall be a dead weight type equipped with a dial graduated to read directly to 0.0001 inch. The presser foot shall be circular with a diameter of 0.25 ± 0.01 inch. The presser foot and moving parts connected therewith shall be weighted so as to apply a total load of 3 ± 0.1 ounce to the specimen. The presser foot and anvil shall be plane surfaces parallel to each other within 0.0001 inch. Five measurements shall be taken equally spaced across the full width of the bag specimen. No individual measurement shall be less than the nominal thickness and the tolerance, and the average of all five measurements on the unit shall be not greater than the nominal thickness and the tolerance.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Bags of like description in quantities as specified (see 6.2) with an equal number of wire-ties, shall be packaged in a snug fitting paperboard box.

5.1.2 Commercial. Bags of like description in quantities as specified (see 6.2) shall be packaged in accordance with normal commercial practice. The complete package shall be designed to protect the item against damage during shipment, handling and storage.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. The packaged bags shall be packed in a weather resistant fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, to insure delivery at destination, to provide for redistribution by the initial receiving activity, and shall be acceptable by common carrier under National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification.

5.2.2 Commercial. The packaged bags shall be packed in fiberboard boxes to insure delivery at destination, to provide for redistribution by the initial receiving activity, and shall be acceptable by common carrier under National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification.

5.3 Unitization. When shipments to Government depots are full car or truckload, the shipping containers shall be unitized for shipment and handling in accordance with normal commercial practice. The unitized load shall not exceed 2,500 pounds in weight, 63 inches in height, 56 inches in length, and 45 inches in width.

5.4 Marking. Marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The bags covered by this specification are intended for use in the packaging of produce (fruits or vegetables) or poultry.

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6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and style of bag (see 1.2.1).
(c) Bag size or dimensions (see 3.3).
(d) Material thickness (see 3.1).
(e) Printing required (see 3.4).
(f) Quantities required (see 5.1.1 or 5.1.2).
(g) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See Section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 60 cents each.

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